UK FOOD SYSTEMS / RESEARCH PROPOSAL

Mushroom Business

from farm to food platform

A UK commercial feasibility proposal covering premium cultivation, substrate and spawn requirements, capital costs, pricing, composite foods, routes to market and regulatory considerations.

Prepared: 20 October 2026

Commercial planning document | UK prices in GBP | Excludes property purchase

THE INVESTMENT CASE

Executive summary

The best entry strategy is a specialty mushroom grower with a product-development option, not a large commodity mushroom farm and not an immediate fermentation factory. Build demand for fresh oyster, shiitake, king oyster and Lion's Mane first; use the crop to test dried umami ingredients and blended meat alternatives after quality, yield and customer repeat rates are proven.

£148m	£7-14/kg	£70-170k
UK mushroom production value, 2025 [1]	Online wholesale examples: oyster to shiitake [2-4]	Indicative small own-substrate launch budget

Recommendation in one page

- Phase 1 - prove sales: start with purchased colonised fruiting blocks and a 20-40 m² pilot. Sell to chefs, independent grocers and direct customers before investing in a substrate line.
- Phase 2 - own production: move to an insulated leased unit with separate incubation and fruiting zones, controlled fresh-air exchange, humidity, cooling and a small cold store.
- Phase 3 - products: add dried mushroom/umami powder and a plant-protein + mushroom mince or burger. Treat supplements, extracts and mycelium materials as separate, later-stage R&D.;

The commercial logic

The UK production-value series was £149m in 2023, £147m in 2024 and £148m in 2025. That is evidence of an established category, not proof of an easy niche-market opportunity. The opportunity is to capture a premium for freshness, cultivar range, reliable weekly delivery and chef-ready formats rather than compete on low-cost button mushrooms. [1]

Investment gate

Do not commit to the own-substrate facility until at least 8-12 recurring trade customers or equivalent direct demand can absorb the planned first commercial output. Aim for pre-orders or letters of intent covering 50-60% of the first six months of saleable capacity.

What must be true for this to work

Condition	Target to validate
Product-market fit	Chefs and retailers reorder weekly; no dependence on one buyer.
Gross contribution	At least £7/kg on the blended product mix at 300 kg/week, after direct production, packing and delivery costs.
Crop quality	Saleable yield, contamination and shelf-life data tracked by strain and batch.
Cash control	Three months' working capital; short payment terms and planned harvest-to-order.

Scope note: financials are pre-tax planning scenarios. They exclude property purchase, financing, and major structural works; assumptions must be replaced by local lease, energy and supplier quotes before investment.

MARKET & PRICING

A market with two price tiers

The commercial market separates into relatively price-sensitive commodity mushrooms and specialist varieties sold on flavour, appearance, local provenance and availability. Premium listings can be many times the wholesale price, but the farm does not receive the retailer's full shelf price: packaging, wastage, delivery, retailer margin and fulfilment all sit between the grower and consumer.

Observed UK online price points

Product / channel	Listed price	How to interpret it
Oyster mushrooms - wholesale quote [2]	**£6.92/kg**	Online trade quote, dated 31 Aug 2026; useful as a baseline, not a guaranteed farm-gate price.
King oyster - wholesale quote [3]	**£10.98/kg**	Premium culinary format with thick, meaty stem; sales depend on chef familiarity.
Shiitake - wholesale quote [4]	**£14.19/kg**	Higher-value savoury product, but longer crop cycle and substrate choice need testing.
Lion's Mane - premium retailer [5]	**£65/kg**	Retail listing for fresh product; do not use this as a farm-gate forecast. Product formats/weights vary.
Dried mixed mushrooms - supermarket [6]	**£100/kg**	30 g retail pack at £3; drying concentrates flavour and value but introduces processing and packaging costs.

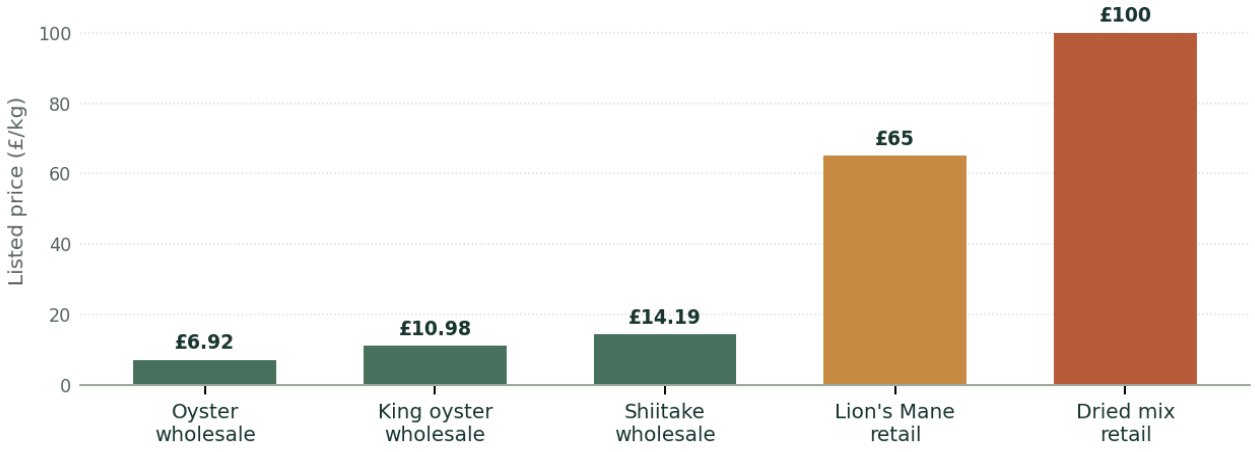


Chart note: the series deliberately mixes wholesale fresh produce and retail processed/rare products. It shows the range of customer price ceilings, not a directly comparable like-for-like price index. Sources [2-6]; accessed 20 October 2026.

Recommended initial crop mix

Species	Starting share of fresh output	Role in the portfolio
Blue / grey oyster	**45-55%**	Core weekly volume; relatively fast crop; accessible to chefs and retail buyers.
King oyster	**15-20%**	Searable "steak" formats; high menu value if chef demand is proven.
Shiitake	**15-20%**	Recognisable culinary mushroom for retail and food-service.
Lion's Mane	**10-15%**	Premium lead product; grow to demand, with strict handling and grade controls.

Avoid starting with too many species. Run 2-3 reliable strains first and expand only when batch records show stable yields, sell-through and repeat orders. Premium retail price is not a substitute for a confirmed buyer.

GROWING MODEL

Spores, spawn and substrate: what you actually buy

Commercially, the recurring input is normally colonised grain spawn (or a purchased colonised fruiting block), not a measured number of loose spores. Spores or a liquid culture are the starting genetics; they are propagated under sterile conditions into inoculum, then expanded into prepared substrate. For a first farm, buying spawn or ready-to-fruit blocks reduces contamination risk and lets the team learn sales and crop handling before building a lab.

Indicative starter culture cost

A UK supplier lists 10 ml liquid cultures at £9.99 each [7]. Budget roughly £30-£100 for a small initial set of 3-5 strains, plus delivery and basic quality control. This is a culture-starting cost, not the amount of inoculum needed for weekly commercial production.

Batch example: a 100 kg hydrated substrate run

Input / assumption	Illustrative quantity	Meaning
Hydrated substrate	**100 kg**	For example, pasteurised straw or hardwood-based mix; actual recipe differs by species.
Moisture level	**60-65% water**	Leaves about 35-40 kg dry substrate solids.
Spawn rate	**5-10 kg**	UF/IFAS guidance describes 5-10% by volume or weight for oyster cultivation [8]; commercial rate varies by system.
Theoretical fresh yield	**28-40 kg**	At 80-100% biological efficiency on dry substrate; saleable output is lower after contamination, undersized fruit and handling losses. Research on oyster yield varies significantly with substrate and preparation [9].

Annual input requirement at different production targets

Target sales	Fresh output/year (48 weeks)	Dry substrate solids/year*	Hydrated substrate/year*	Spawn/year at 5-8% wet weight*
150 kg/week	**7.2 t**	7.2-9.0 t	18-23 t	0.9-1.8 t
300 kg/week	**14.4 t**	14.4-18.0 t	36-45 t	1.8-3.6 t
500 kg/week	**24.0 t**	24.0-30.0 t	60-75 t	3.0-6.0 t

*Planning calculation assumes 80-100% biological efficiency, 40% dry matter in hydrated substrate, and 5-8% spawn as a share of hydrated substrate weight. These are engineering assumptions to be tested; production systems may quote spawn rate on a different basis. Confirm with the spawn supplier and crop trials before procurement.

Core process and equipment

- Separate clean inoculation / incubation / fruiting / pack-out functions as scale grows; protect clean zones from spores and contaminated material.
- Control fresh-air exchange and carbon dioxide as well as humidity and temperature. Humid air without adequate ventilation produces poor shape and inconsistent quality.
- Record strain, substrate recipe, pasteurisation/sterilisation conditions, spawn lot, batch date, flush yields, contamination, grade-out and customer complaints.
- Spent substrate can become a secondary compost/soil-improver stream, but validate contamination and any sale/use requirements before marketing it.

PRODUCT STRATEGY

From fresh mushrooms to composite foods

Mushrooms are valuable in composite foods because they contribute savoury flavour, texture, moisture and fibre. They are not, by themselves, a high-protein replacement for meat: fresh mushrooms contain substantial water, so protein density and cooking losses must be checked against the finished recipe. The best proposition is a tasty hybrid plant formulation that uses mushrooms for eating quality and legumes/grains for protein and structure.

A focused product ladder

Product	Illustrative format	Why it could work	Priority
1. Chef-grade fresh range	Blue oyster, king oyster, shiitake, Lion's Mane, mixed boxes	Fastest way to validate cultivation and weekly demand; low product-development burden.	**Launch**
2. Dried mushroom / umami powder	20-50 g consumer pack; 0.5-1 kg chef pouch	Extends use and captures value from suitable surplus/trim; strong use in stocks, sauces, gravy, noodles and seasoning.	**Phase 2**
3. Mushroom mince / burger	Chopped mushrooms + pea/fava protein + oats/fibre + seasoning	Texture, umami and familiarity can reduce the need for expensive meat-like processing. Requires food-safety and shelf-life development.	**Phase 2**
4. King oyster "steak" / pulled mushroom	Marinated thick-cut stem or shredded cooked product	Visual and texture-led centrepiece for food service; sell as a mushroom dish rather than claim equivalence to meat.	**Phase 2**
5. Ready meals, sauces, pâté	Chilled sauce, soup, pie filling or mushroom spread	Higher basket value and use of varied grades; higher burden for processing, packaging and shelf-life validation.	**Phase 3**
6. Mycelium composites	Packaging, protective foam, panels or non-food materials	Potential circular-economy R&D;, but a different market, material specification and capital path. Not a near-term core revenue assumption.	**Separate R&D;**

Prototype brief: mushroom + plant-protein mince

First formulation to test - not a validated commercial recipe

Start with 40-55% chopped, cooked and drained mushrooms; 20-30% pea or fava protein ingredient; 10-20% oats or other binder/fibre; the balance as oil, herbs, spices, salt and moisture control. Test 2-3 variants for bite, juiciness, cooking loss, cost per 150 g serving, nutrition, allergens and consumer preference. Formulation percentages are a development starting point; do not make nutrition claims until the finished product is analysed.

Dried format: high-value but process-led

Retail listings demonstrate the apparent value of dried mushrooms: a 30 g mixed pack listed at £3 equals £100/kg at shelf price [6]. That is not the margin available to the farm. Model dehydration yield, power use, food-grade handling, packaging, breakage, lab testing, retailer margin and unsold stock. Start with small batches and sell directly to chefs before investing in a dedicated line.

Fungi fermentation is a different technology

Quorn's mycoprotein is made from Fusarium venenatum in specialist fermentation infrastructure, not by simply growing culinary mushroom caps [13]. A small farm should not assume it can economically compete with industrial mycoprotein on protein per kilogram. Its near-term opportunity is culinary fruiting bodies, blended foods and ingredients.

CAPITAL REQUIREMENTS

What the farm costs to start

A rented, washable light-industrial unit is usually a more defensible first step than buying land or commissioning a purpose-built farm. The correct budget depends on whether the business buys finished fruiting blocks, makes its own substrate, or also manufactures packaged foods. The ranges below are initial planning allowances, not supplier quotes.

Three launch sizes

Model	Indicative initial funding	What it includes	Use case
Market-test pilot	**£12k-£30k**	20-40 m², bought colonised blocks, basic humidification/air exchange, racks, a small chiller, packing bench, labels and working cash.	Validate chef and retail demand with minimal process complexity.
Small own-substrate unit	**£70k-£170k**	Roughly 50-120 m², insulated fruiting/incubation rooms, substrate prep and pasteurisation/sterilisation, controls, cold store, quality systems and 3 months working capital.	Preferred first commercial facility after signed demand.
Regional commercial farm	**£180k-£400k+**	Larger unit, more growing rooms, material-handling equipment, redundancy and a bigger packing/cold-chain set-up. Major fit-out can push this much higher.	Scale after stable year-round utilisation.

Example budget: small own-substrate unit

Item	Budget range	Comment
Lease deposit, drainage and washable fit-out	**£8k-£18k**	No property purchase; verify planning/use, power supply and drainage before lease.
Insulated rooms, racks and handling	**£14k-£31k**	Separate incubation and fruiting zones; modular is easier to expand.
Substrate preparation and pasteurisation/sterilisation	**£6k-£18k**	Steam, boiler/autoclave and cleanable mixing/filling equipment; requirements depend on substrate and process.
Humidity, air handling, filters, sensors and controls	**£7k-£16k**	Fresh air, humidity, temperature and CO2 monitoring are production essentials.
Cold store, wash/pack bench, scales and sealing	**£5k-£12k**	Protect quality and reduce post-harvest losses.
Electrical / water / fire safety / installation	**£5k-£12k**	Get site-specific contractor quotes before committing to premises.
Brand, web sales, packaging, food-safety tests	**£2k-£5k**	Keep packaging simple; develop a traceability and recall system from day one.
Initial substrate/spawn/packaging inventory	**£3k-£6k**	Reorder cycles must match actual sales and yield.
Working capital (roughly 3 months)	**£15k-£30k**	Payroll, rent, energy, fuel, customer payment terms and crop failure reserve.

Allow a contingency

Add 10-20% for fit-out surprises and commissioning. The table is intended to land broadly in the £70k-£170k range after contingency and working capital; local building condition is the largest unknown. Do not assume grant support until eligibility and award timing are confirmed.

Cost-control choices

- Buy fruiting blocks to prove demand before purchasing an autoclave, boiler or laboratory kit.
- Use a modular room design, but do not economise on washable surfaces, ventilation, humidity control or refrigeration.
- Get at least three quotes for spawn, substrate, electricity, cold storage, packaging and chilled delivery. Bulk substrate prices differ sharply from hobby-pack prices [7].

FINANCIAL MODEL

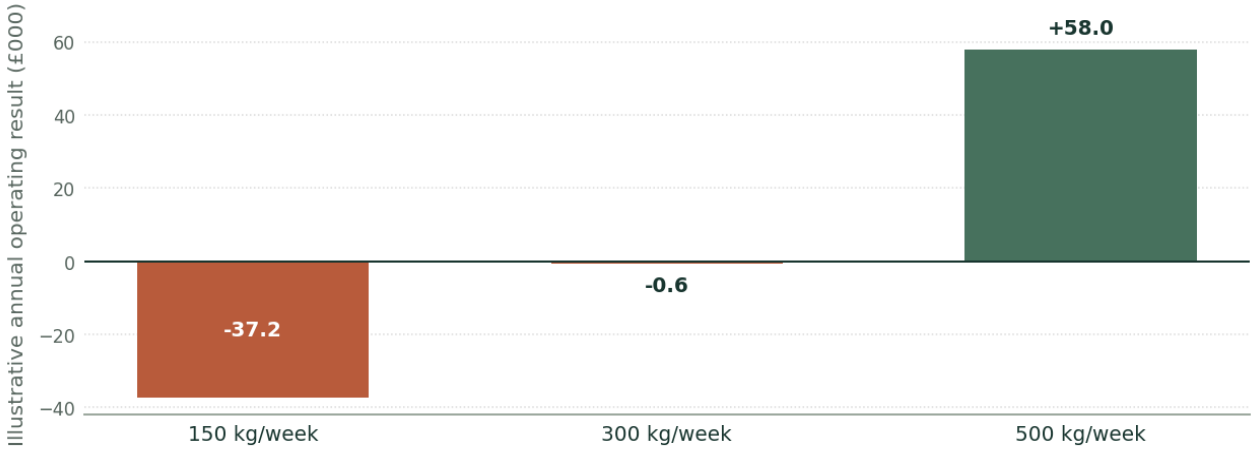
Scale and realised price decide profitability

The farm is not automatically profitable because fresh mushroom retail prices look high. At low volume, rent, labour, packing and delivery absorb the margin. The model below is a simple annual operating illustration: 48 saleable production weeks, a blended average selling price by channel, variable costs that scale with volume, and tiered fixed overhead. Replace every assumption with quotes and pilot data.

Annual scenarios

Metric	Pilot: 150 kg/wk	Base: 300 kg/wk	Scale: 500 kg/wk
Fresh output	7.2 t/year	14.4 t/year	24.0 t/year
Blended realised price	£12.00/kg	£13.50/kg	£14.50/kg
Revenue	**£86.4k**	**£194.4k**	**£348.0k**
Variable cost/kg	£6.75	£6.25	£6.25
Variable costs	£48.6k	£90.0k	£150.0k
Contribution after variable costs	**£37.8k**	**£104.4k**	**£198.0k**
Fixed overhead incl. staffing	£75.0k	£105.0k	£140.0k
Operating result	**-£37.2k**	**-£0.6k**	**+£58.0k**

The fixed-overhead allowance includes rent, core payroll/employer costs, routine maintenance, insurance, basic admin and base utility costs; variable costs cover substrate, spawn, supplementation, consumables, packaging, production-dependent energy and delivery allowances. These are not audited accounts and exclude finance, depreciation and tax. Labour allocation needs refining with a timed harvest/packing study.



Base case break-even

At 300 kg/week, a 48-week year gives 14,400 kg. If the blended selling price is £13.50/kg and variable cost is £6.25/kg, contribution is £7.25/kg. With £105,000 fixed overhead, break-even is about 14,483 kg/year, or 302 kg/week. This means the base case is effectively at break-even; it does not create an adequate return for the capital risk unless prices or productivity improve.

Sensitivity at 300 kg/week

Average realised price	Annual revenue	Operating result*
£11/kg	£158.4k	**-£36.6k**
£13.50/kg	£194.4k	**-£0.6k**
£16/kg	£230.4k	**+£35.4k**

*Assumes variable cost of £6.25/kg and fixed overhead of £105,000. The key commercial metric is contribution per kg by channel, not retail shelf price alone.

GO-TO-MARKET

Sell weekly, harvest to demand

Fresh gourmet mushrooms are perishable. Plan the sales operation first: schedule batches against standing orders, keep the product list short and create an outlet for lower-grade but safe fruit. A farm with high yields but weak distribution will lose value quickly.

Priority sales channels

Channel	Offer	Commercial design
Independent restaurants / chefs	Weekly chef boxes, species-specific packs, menu notes and consistent delivery day.	Main route for first volumes. Offer sample box, then set minimum order and delivery radius.
Independent grocers / farm shops	150-250 g trays, mixed mushroom packs and recipe cards.	Start with 5-10 stores. Agree case size, returns policy and promotion calendar.
Direct-to-consumer	Weekly mixed box, subscription or click-and-collect.	Higher selling price but higher customer-acquisition and fulfilment cost. Use local delivery first.
Food manufacturers / caterers	Regular bulk grades for mince, sauces, soups and fillings.	Requires specification, food safety systems, dependable volume and agreed forecast.
Processed products	Dried umami ingredient, mushroom burger/mince and chef sauce.	Develop in small batches with a competent co-manufacturer or approved production space.

First 90 days: research and validation plan

Weeks	Workstream	Deliverable / decision gate
1-2	**Buyer discovery**	Interview 20 chefs, 10 retailers and 3 food manufacturers. Capture species, pack size, price, weekly volume, delivery day, rejection reasons and payment terms.
2-4	**Pilot supply**	Source two spawn/block suppliers; grow or buy trial batches; obtain substrate, packing and chilled-delivery quotes; log losses.
3-6	**Price validation**	Offer paid samples, not just free tastings. Secure repeat orders and test three price points by channel.
5-8	**Process validation**	Run at least 3 batch cycles per species/strain; measure saleable yield, labour minutes/kg, energy, contamination and shelf-life.
7-10	**Composite prototyping**	Make 2-3 small plant-protein + mushroom prototypes with a food technologist; collect blind taste and cooking-loss data.
10-12	**Investment review**	Build a buyer-backed weekly demand schedule and quote-based cash-flow model. Proceed only if capacity, gross margin and working capital are credible.

Operational KPIs to record weekly

- Saleable yield (kg) per kg dry substrate; contamination rate; grade-out percentage; kg sold by channel; realised price; returned / wasted product.
- Labour minutes per kg; kWh per kg; substrate and spawn cost per kg sold; delivery cost per order; debtors days; cash runway.
- Repeat order rate; customer concentration; complaints; batch-to-batch quality; proportion of output committed before harvest.

Go / no-go rule

Only expand capacity when the current unit has several consecutive months of repeat sales, a contribution margin above the fixed-cost break-even requirement, and enough working capital to cover crop losses and delayed customer payments.

COMPLIANCE & RISK

Food safety is part of the production system

Fresh cultivation is relatively straightforward compared with manufacturing supplements, complex ready meals or fermentation-derived ingredients, but a mushroom farm that handles, packs or sells food still has to operate as a food business. Confirm requirements with the relevant local authority before fitting out premises.

UK compliance checklist

- Register the food business: in England, Wales and Northern Ireland, registration is required at least 28 days before trading; it is free. Confirm the route with the relevant council / devolved authority. [10]
- Food safety management: maintain a HACCP-based system, cleaning and pest-control records, supplier and batch traceability, temperature control, recall procedures and a validated shelf-life approach. [10]
- Packaged products and allergens: check ingredient declarations, nutrition labelling applicability, allergen controls and date/storage instructions. Food businesses must provide allergen information. [10, 11]
- Claims and supplements: do not claim that Lion’s Mane or another product treats, prevents or cures disease. Nutrition/health claims are regulated; verify permitted claims before any label, advert or influencer campaign. [11]
- Novel foods: ordinary culinary mushrooms and novel extracts are not necessarily treated the same. Before selling unusual species, concentrated extracts, new fermentation ingredients or novel processes, check the current FSA/FSS guidance and authorisation status. [12]
- Plant-based composite foods: early prototypes should avoid meat ingredients to simplify manufacturing. If adding meat or other regulated ingredients later, get specific advice on establishment approval, hygiene and product labelling.

Risk register and mitigations

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Contamination / crop failure	Lost output and wasted substrate	Clean/dirty zoning, batch records, validated pasteurisation/sterilisation, smaller early batches and supplier backup.
Weak price realisation	Sales below break-even contribution	Paid buyer trials, multiple channels, pre-orders and price-by-species tracking.
Spoilage / delivery failure	Returns, waste and reputation damage	Harvest-to-order, rapid chilling, limited radius initially, validated packaging and delivery trials.
Energy / labour intensity	Margin erosion	Meter kWh and labour minutes per kg; use insulated rooms, efficient airflow and repeatable handling.
Regulatory claims / shelf life	Recall, enforcement or rework	Use a food technologist / lab; maintain a claim approval and label change process.
Single-customer dependence	Demand shock or payment delay	Set a customer concentration limit and diversify trade/retail/direct buyers.

Circular-economy angle

Spent substrate and suitable offcuts may provide secondary value as compost/soil improver, but test for contamination and establish a lawful, dependable outlet. Mycelium-grown packaging or panels could become a separate innovation project; it should not be included in first-year revenue forecasts. Keep food-contact, material performance and biodegradation validation distinct from the fresh-food business.

INVESTMENT PLAN

The proposed business architecture

Build the firm as three connected but separately measured lines: fresh cultivation for recurring cash sales; food products to monetise flavour, convenience and selected surplus; and mycelium materials as an optional R&D; pathway. The first line pays for learning. The second builds brand value. The third should be funded only after the food business has operating data and a technical partner.

Recommended sequencing

Stage	Capital decision	Success evidence
0. Demand validation	£2k-£8k for market work, paid pilot batches, food technologist advice and supplier quotes.	Buyer interviews converted into paid samples, written demand indications and channel-specific price/volume data.
1. Market-test pilot	Cumulative £12k-£30k using ready-to-fruit blocks.	Several months of repeat orders; actual yield, labour, cold-chain cost and customer acquisition measured.
2. Own-substrate farm	£70k-£170k after quote-based investment review.	Pre-sold demand for 50-60% of planned output; target contribution ≥£7/kg; adequate 3-month working capital.
3. Composite food line	Separate £10k-£40k development allowance as a rough planning range, subject to co-manufacturer and testing quotes.	Sensory wins, repeat B2B buyer, validated shelf life, costed recipe, compliant labelling and positive contribution.
4. Regional scaling / materials	£180k-£400k+ scale funding only after demand and operating discipline are established.	Reliable production, 6-12 months management accounts, stable energy/labour KPIs and contracted volumes.

What would change the conclusion?

- If local chef demand is much smaller than planned, stay as a low-capital block grower or abandon own cultivation rather than overbuild.
- If the business secures a reliable premium buyer for Lion’s Mane or king oyster, increase that crop only after repeatable grade and yield data.
- If composite foods win paid trials, partner with an approved co-manufacturer before buying a processing line. Recipe novelty is not evidence of manufacturability.
- If spawn costs dominate, compare supplier economics with a staged in-house spawn capability; do not build a sterile lab before the core growing operation is stable.

Overall recommendation

Proceed with a 90-day customer and cultivation validation programme, not a full-scale build. The core hypothesis is that a reliable, chef-focused local grower can achieve a blended realised price and contribution margin high enough to fund a small farm. The financial model shows that 300 kg/week is approximately break-even under base assumptions; a commercially attractive result likely requires stronger pricing, lower unit costs, or scale toward 500 kg/week without sacrificing product quality.

Key due-diligence questions before funding

Question	Evidence required
Can we sell 300-500 kg/week?	Named buyers, species mix, weekly volumes, pack specs, price, return terms and payment days.
What is the true cost per saleable kg?	Three crop cycles, actual output, contamination, labour, energy, packing and delivery records.
Can premium pricing persist?	Repeat orders and paid price tests, not only competitor list prices.
Are the premises fit for purpose?	Local authority / planning check, landlord consent, drainage, power capacity, extraction, cold storage and service quotes.

EVIDENCE BASE

Sources and reference notes

Online prices and guidance were checked on 20 October 2026 where pages were accessible. Retail and supplier listings can change and are not equivalent to signed supply quotations. Yield, cost and financial modelling assumptions are identified as planning assumptions in the body of the report.

[1] Department for Environment, Food & Rural Affairs (DEFRA), “Agriculture in the United Kingdom 2025, Chapter 7: Crops”, Table 7.8a. Mushroom production value: £149m (2023), £147m (2024), £148m (2025).
https://www.gov.uk/government/statistics/agriculture-in-the-united-kingdom-2025/chapter-7-crops

[2] Foodomarket, “Oyster mushrooms wholesale price UK”, quoted at £6.92/kg on 31 August 2026.
https://www.foodomarket.com/en-gb/products/fresh-fruits-and-vegetables/oyster-mushrooms-509

[3] Foodomarket, “Eryngii / king oyster mushroom wholesale price UK”, quoted at £10.98/kg on 31 August 2026.
https://www.foodomarket.com/en-gb/products/fresh-fruits-and-vegetables/eryngii-king-oyster-mushroom

[4] Foodomarket, “Shiitake mushrooms wholesale price UK”, quoted at £14.19/kg on 31 August 2026.
https://www.foodomarket.com/en-gb/products/fresh-fruits-and-vegetables/shiitake-mushrooms

[5] Panzer’s, “Lion’s Mane Mushroom”, retailer listing at £65/kg; retail pricing, not grower realisation.
https://panzers.co.uk/product/lions-mane-mushroom/

[6] Tesco Groceries, “Merchant Gourmet Dried Mixed Mushrooms 30g”, listed at £3.00 (£100/kg) when checked.
https://www.tesco.com/shop/en-GB/products/317300425

[7] Spore Supplies, product and wholesale mushroom substrate pellet pages. A 10 ml oyster liquid culture is listed at £9.99; wholesale oak and master-mix pellet products are also listed on the supplier site. Obtain actual pallet weight, delivered price and VAT treatment from supplier.
https://sporesupplies.co.uk/products/branched-oyster-pleurotus-cornocopiae-10ml-mushroom-liquid-culture
Wholesale mushroom substrate pellets page

[8] University of Florida IFAS Extension, “Grow Your Own Oyster Mushrooms” (SS662). Describes inoculating pasteurised straw at 5-10% spawn by volume or weight.
https://ask.ifas.ufl.edu/publication/SS662

[9] Vieira, F.R. and Andrade, M.C.N. (2016), “Optimization of substrate preparation for oyster mushroom cultivation…”, World Journal of Microbiology and Biotechnology, 32, article 190; reports material-dependent yield and biological efficiency, including wheat-straw results around 86%.
https://pure.psu.edu/en/publications/optimization-of-substrate-preparation-for-oyster-mushroom-pleurot/

[10] Food Standards Agency / GOV.UK, “Starting a food business”. Registration, food safety management, HACCP-based procedures, traceability and allergen information.
https://www.gov.uk/guidance/starting-a-food-business

[11] GOV.UK, “Food labelling and packaging: Nutrition, health claims and supplement labelling”. Nutrition/health claims rules and prohibition on claims that foods treat, prevent or cure disease.
https://www.gov.uk/food-labelling-and-packaging/nutrition-health-claims-and-supplement-labelling

[12] Food Standards Agency, “Innovative Food Guidance Hub”, updated June 2026. Check whether unusual species, new extracts, processes or ingredients require novel-food authorisation.
https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/innovative-food-guidance-hub/innovative-food-guidance-hub

[13] Quorn, “What is Quorn mycoprotein?” and “How is Quorn made?” Describes Fusarium venenatum fermentation and downstream processing; illustrates the distinction between mycoprotein fermentation and culinary fruiting-body cultivation.
https://www.quornnutrition.com/mycoprotein/what-is-mycoprotein

[14] Food Standards Agency, “Allergen guidance for food businesses”, updated 14 March 2025.
https://www.food.gov.uk/business-guidance/allergen-guidance-for-food-businesses

Method and limitations

The report combines official UK statistics, current public product listings, cultivation guidance and scenario-based business modelling. Public prices may include different pack formats and terms. Spawn rate and biological-efficiency calculations depend on the species, strain, substrate moisture, substrate preparation and the basis used for spawn percentage. Capital budgets are indicative estimates for a leased small facility; they should not be presented to a lender as quotations. Before investment, commission supplier quotations, a premises and planning review, product shelf-life work, and a spreadsheet model populated with the farm’s own trials.

End of proposal